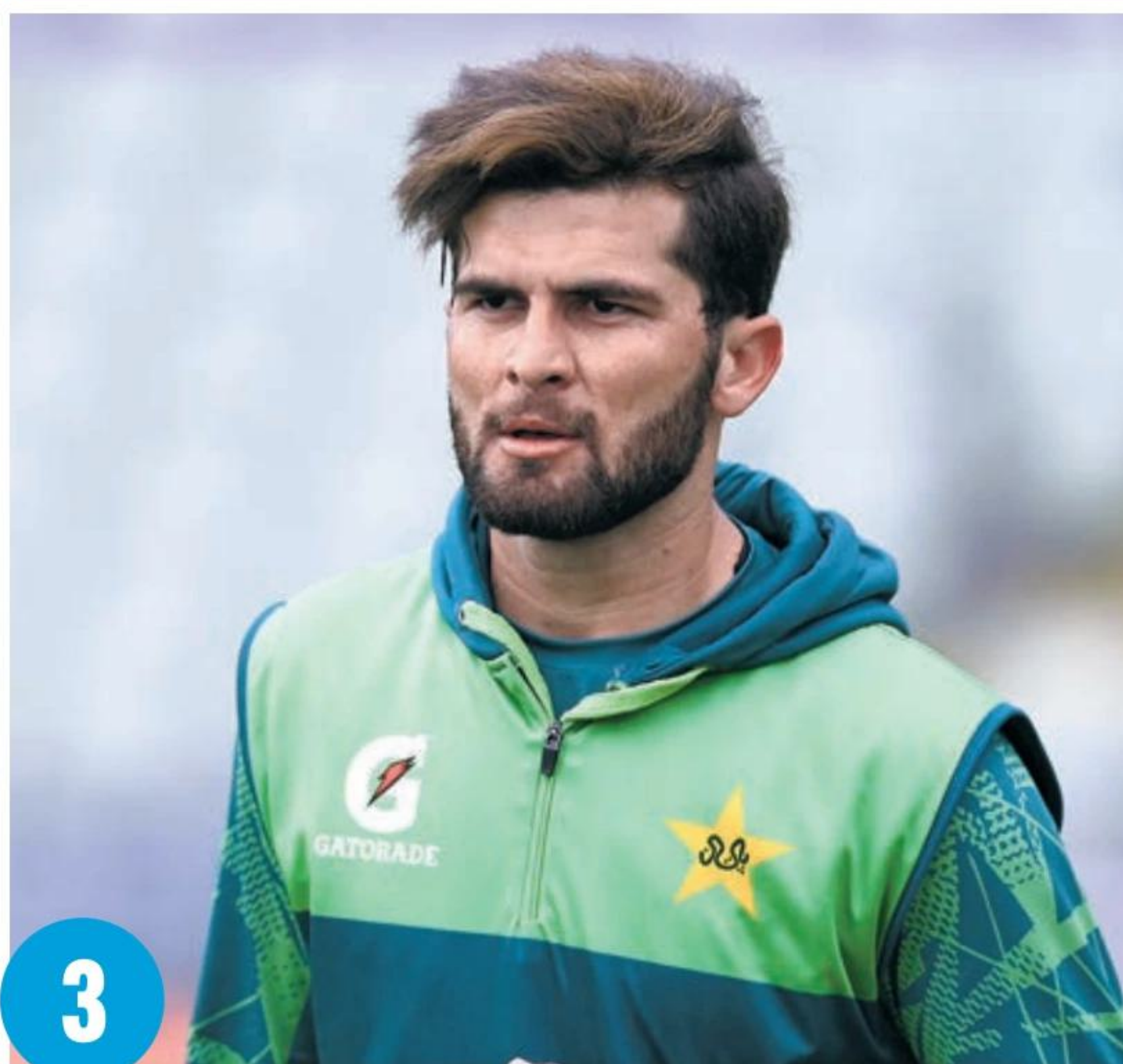




2

PTI

Rishabh Pant will mark his return from a foot injury by captaining India A in two four-day games against South Africa A in Bengaluru, starting October 30. Cleared by the BCCI's Centre of Excellence after rehab, Pant will skip Delhi's second Ranji round. Vice-captain B Sai Sudharsan will also play both matches, while KL Rahul, Dhruv Jurel, Prasidh Krishna, and Mohammed Siraj join for the second fixture from November 6. All are expected to feature in India's Test squad for the South Africa series beginning November 14 in Kolkata.



3

GETTY IMAGES

Shaheen Afridi has been named Pakistan's new ODI captain. The 25-year-old left-arm pacer will begin his leadership stint against South Africa in a three-match ODI series starting November 4. Since his debut in 2018, Shaheen has played 66 ODIs, taking 131 wickets at an average of 24.28, and has firmly established himself as Pakistan's spearhead across formats.



4

AFP

Afghanistan turned the tables on Bangladesh in emphatic fashion, sealing a 3-0 ODI series sweep with a crushing 200-run win in Abu Dhabi. After posting a commanding 293 for 9, with Ibrahim Zadran **(in pic)** making 95 off 111 balls, its bowlers dismantled Bangladesh for a meek 93, completing a demolition that mirrored the 3-0 drubbing Afghanistan had suffered in the T20Is prior. It was the fifth ODI series win on the bounce for Afghanistan.



5

Pics: GETTY IMAGES

Kane Williamson and Nathan Smith have returned to New Zealand's 14-member squad for the upcoming three-match ODI series against England. Both last featured in ODI cricket during the Champions Trophy final against India in March but missed the start of the home season due to injuries. Williamson has recovered from a recent minor medical issue, while Smith has regained full fitness after suffering an abdominal injury during the second Test against Zimbabwe in August.